

Local Dispatch

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COVER STORY

Try a URL Sandbox! (For Free!)

TLDR: Want to open shady or weird links without wrecking your computer?

Peteris Krumins (catonmat)

Use a free URL sandbox at browserling.com/browse . It runs remotely outside of your browser. No installs, no downloads. Just click and go.

What's a URL Sandbox?

A URL sandbox is a safe place to open websites. It's like using a remote computer. When you visit a site in the sandbox, it's not actually loading on your device, it's loading on a remote machine in remote data center. That means viruses, popups, or anything sketchy stays far away from you.

Why Use a URL Sandbox?

Sometimes you get a link that look weird. Maybe it's from a sketchy email, a random message, or a website that just feels off. You don't want to risk opening it on your real browser.

With a URL sandbox, you can open that link in an isolated virtual machine. If it's dangerous, it can't hurt your system. It's like opening a snake cage, but you're behind bulletproof glass.

Do I Need to Install Anything?

Nope. No installs. No downloads. No setup. Just go to browserling.com/browse , paste your URL, and you'll get a sandboxed browser. It works right in your current browser, and nothing gets saved on your device.

Can I Choose Different Browsers?

Yep. You can try out Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari, even old versions of Internet Explorer. This is super useful if you're testing how a website looks or behaves in different browsers. Or if you're trying to trigger something that only runs in a certain browser version (like a 0-day payload).

Is It Free?

Yes, there's a free URL sandbox version. You get a few minutes to test things. If you need more time or more features (like geo-browsing or file uploads), there are paid options too.

How Is A URL Sandbox Different From Antivirus?

Antivirus software scans your device after something is downloaded or opened. A URL sandbox blocks the danger before it ever touches your system. With a URL sandbox, you're stopping danger at the door, not cleaning up the mess afterward.

Can I Use It To Open Suspicious Email Links?

Yes, and you should. If you get a weird link in an email, just drop it into the sandbox and check it safely. It keeps you out of harm's way and lets you see what the link does without risking your device.

Is It Safe for Testing Malware?

Yes, it's one of the safest ways to do it. Security researchers use URL sandboxes every day to analyze malware behavior in a fully isolated space. It's a controlled, no-risk way to see how dangerous files or links act.

What Is Browserling?

Browserling is the tool that powers a free URL sandbox. It gives you access to real web browsers running on remote computers. You're basically "remote controlling" a safe browser that lives in the cloud. With Browserling you can browse safely, test websites in different browsers, open risky files like sketchy PDFs, and click links without worrying.

Who Uses Browserling?

Millions of people! Developers, security teams, schools, IT pros, and even government agencies. Companies use it to test websites. Cybersecurity folks use it to investigate shady stuff. Regular users use it to stay safe online.

Browse safe!

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FEATURES

Solid Relevance

Robert C Martin (Clean Coder)

Recently I received a letter from someone with a concern. It went like this:

For years the knowledge of the SOLID principle has been a standard part of our recruiting procedure. Candidates were expected to have a good working knowledge of these principles. Lately, however, one of our managers, who doesn't code much anymore, has questioned whether that is wise. His points were that the Open-Closed principle isn't very important anymore because most of the code we write isn't contained in large monoliths and making changes to small microservices is safe and easy. The Liskov Substitution Principle is long out of date because we don't focus on inheritance nearly as much as we did 20 years ago. I think we should consider Dan North's position on SOLID – "Just write simple code."

I wrote the following letter in response:

The SOLID principles remain as relevant to day as they were in the 90s (and indeed before that). This is because software hasn't changed all that much in all those years — and that is because software hasn't change all that much since 1945 when Turing wrote the first lines of code for an electronic computer. Software is still if statements, while loops, and assignment statements — Sequence , Selection , and Iteration .

Every new generation likes to think that their world is vastly different from the generation before. Every new generation is wrong about that; which is something that every new generation learns once the next new generation comes along to tell them how much everything has changed.

So let's walk through the principles, one by one.

SRP) The Single Responsibility Principle.

Gather together the things that change for the same reasons. Separate things that change for different reasons.

It is hard to imagine that this principle is not relevant in software. We do not mix business rules with GUI code. We do not mix SQL queries with communications protocols. We keep code that is changed for different reasons separate so that changes to one part do not break other parts. We make sure that modules that change for different reasons do not have dependencies that tangle them.

Microservices do not solve this problem. You can create a tangled microservice, or a tangled set of microservices if you mix code that changes for different reasons.

Dan North's slides completely miss the point on this, and convinces me that he did not understand the principle at all. (or that he was being ironic, which knowing Dan, is far more likely) His answer to the SRP is to "Write Simple Code". I agree. The SRP is one of the ways we keep the code simple.

OCP) The Open-Closed Principle.

A Module should be open for extension but closed for modification.

Of all the principles, the idea that anyone would question this one fills me full of dread for the future of our industry. Of course we want to create modules that can be extended without modifying them. Can you imagine working in a system that did not have device independence, where writing to a disk file was fundamentally different than writing to a printer, or a screen, or a pipe? Do we want to see if statement scattered through our code to deal with all the little details?

Or... Do we want to separate abstract concepts from detailed concepts. Do we want to keep business rules isolated from the nasty little details of the GUI, and the micro-service communications protocols, and the arbitrary behaviors of the database? Of course we do!

Again, Dan's slide gets this completely wrong. When requirements change only part of the existing code is wrong. Much of the existing code is still right. And we want to make sure that we don't have to change the right code just to make the wrong code work again. Dan's answer is "write simple code". Again, I agree. And, ironically, he is right. Simple code is both open and closed .

LSP) The Liskov Substitution Principle.

A program that uses an interface must not be confused by an implementation of that interface.

People (including me) have made the mistake that this is about inheritance. It is not. It is about sub-typing. All implementations of interfaces are subtypes of an interface. All duck-types are subtypes of an implied interface. And, every user of the base interface, whether declared or implied, must agree on the meaning of that interface. If an implementation confuses the user of the base type, then if/switch statements will proliferate.

This principle is about keeping abstractions crisp and well-defined. It is impossible to believe that this is an outmoded concept.

Dan's slides are entirely correct on this topic; he simply missed the point of the principle. Simple code is code that maintains crisp subtype relationships.

ISP) The Interface Segregation Principle.

Keep interfaces small so that users don't end up depending on things they don't need.

We still work with compiled languages. We still depend upon modification dates to determine which modules should be recompiled and redeployed. So long as this is true we will have to face the problem that when module A depends on module B at compile time, but not at run time, then changes to module B will force recompilation and

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Open Letter to the Linux Foundation

Robert C Martin (Clean Coder)

To: The Linux Foundation

Jim Zemlin: Executive Director

Angela Brown: VP of Events

Andy Updegrave: Legal Council

From: Robert Martin (@unclebobmartin) (uncle-bob@cleancoder.com)

Re: Code of Conduct case of Charles Max Wood.

Dear Linux Foundation:

I am writing to you as a concerned member of the software development community which I have enjoyed serving for the last 50 years. I am writing in public because the events I wish to describe took place in public. I fear that something has gone terribly wrong within your organization; and that it will have deep repercussions within this industry that I cherish.

The timeline of events, as far as I can determine them, is as follows:

The Linux Foundation received a public tweet sent to the @KubeCon twitter address. That tweet recommended that Kube Con discontinue their association with Charles Max Wood. The reasons given in this complaint were his request for an open and civil phone call, and a picture of Mr. Wood wearing a MAGA hat.

The Linux Foundation publicly replied from the @linux-foundation twitter account as follows:

Hi all, We have reviewed social and videos and determined that the Event Code of Conduct was violated and his registration to the event has been revoked. Our events should and will be a safe space.

First let me say that I find it highly problematic that the complaint and the decision were public. Indeed I am surprised that LF would accept a publicly submitted code of conduct complaint. I am much more than surprised that LF would ever consider publicly responding to such a complaint. Indeed, it seems to me that the public complaint, and perhaps even the public response by LF, could be seen as public harassment – which is explicitly prohibited by the LF Code of Conduct.

It seems to me that Code of Conduct complaints made in public must be immediately rejected and viewed as Code of Conduct violations in and of themselves. Code of Conduct complaints should be submitted in private and remain private and confidential in order to prevent their use as a means of harassment. It also seems to me that while the process of accepting, reviewing, and adjudicating such

complaints should be public, the proceedings and decision of each individual case should remain private and confidential in order to protect the parties from harm. Making them a public showcase is, simply, horrible.

Was the Code of Conduct actually violated by Mr. Wood? I have watched the videos in question and read the tweets and I can find no instance where Mr Wood violated the LF Code of Conduct. I understand that LF can make any decision they like about what constitutes a Code of Conduct violation. However, when both the complaint and the response are so blatantly public, it seems to me that LF owes it to the observing community to explain their decision and describe the due process that was used to make it – including the decision to make the public response that undoubtedly caused harm to Mr. Wood. To date no such explanation has been forthcoming, despite repeated requests.

The software community needs to understand how decisions like this are going to be made. Otherwise those of us who have watched this case may be forced to conclude that LF has no internal process, that no due diligence will be applied to Code of Conduct complaints and determinations, that the accused will have no rights either of appeal or privacy, that LF feels free to make its decisions based on the blowing of political winds, and will loudly announce their decisions regardless of the harm it might cause.

Therefore I have the following questions:

Why was the initial complaint accepted and acknowledged in public? It was clearly political in nature, and very clearly intended to cause harm to Mr. Wood.

Is it LF policy to accept complaints that, in and of themselves, violate the LF Code of Conduct?

Why was the Code of Conduct determination announced publicly, despite the harm it would obviously cause to Mr. Wood?

Can LF specifically justify the determination that Mr. Wood violated the Code of Conduct?

Does LF have a documented process by which Code of Conduct complaints are to be submitted, reviewed, and adjudicated?

Is it LF policy to consider political affiliation, or support of certain public officials, as Code of Conduct violations?

Is it LF policy to publicly denounce registrants who have been determined to have violated the LF Code of Conduct?

Does LF have a Code of Conduct for how it conducts itself?

In summary, it appears to this humble observer that The Code of Conduct process at The Linux Foundation went very badly off the rails with regard to Charles Max Wood. That LF owes Mr. Wood, and the Software Community at large, a profound apology. That LF should keep all future Code of Conduct complaints and decisions personal and confidential.

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standard-article(title: [A New HBO Series, ‘The Dark Wizard,’ Examines the Life and Death of Climbing Legend Dean Potter], author: [awise], source-name: [Outside Magazine], images: (), paragraphs: ([Dean Potter isn’t a name you forget. On May 16, 2015, the famous climber and BASE jumper fell to his death after a wingsuit flight in Yosemite. He was 43 years old.], [I had just started working for Outside as a news writer and social media manager a couple of weeks earlier. I stumbled upon the news on an old climbing forum, and those far more senior than I worked to verify the facts. Even as someone not deeply embedded in the hardcore climbing scene and brand new to the outdoor industry at the time, I was familiar with Dean’s career and knew the community had lost a legend.], [Dean Potter became known in the Yosemite climbing world in the 1990s for tackling free-solo (climbing without a rope for protection) climbs in the park. He began to experiment with free-soloing while wearing a parachute for protection, which he called free-basing. Throughout his career, he also tried highlining, wingsuit flights, and BASE jumping, and he created a film about BASE jumping with his small dog, Whisper.], [In 2002, Potter graced the cover of Outside magazine. The accompanying profile, titled “Climbing at the Speed of Soul,” chronicled his talents as a speed climber on El Capitan, where he shattered various records for ascending the toughest routes.], [Photo: HBO]), [Now, a new HBO series that explores the life of Potter is about to be released. The Dark Wizard is directed by Emmy-winning filmmakers Peter Mortimer of The Alpinist, The Dawn Wall, and Valley Uprising and Nick Rosen of Valley Uprising and The Alpinist. It features cameos from big-name climbers like Alex Honnold and Cedar Wright. “He was the most badass motherfucker in the Valley,” says Wright of Potter in the trailer.], [The four-part series premiered at SXSW on March 15, 2026, and will move to HBO on April 14. The Dark Wizard will also be featured in Boulder, Colorado, as part of the BIFF Adventure Film Program , beginning on April 10. Outside received an early release of the trailer for The Dark Wizard, which you can watch above.], [“When I was a little boy, my first memory was this dream of falling,” says Potter in the trailer. “My whole life, I’ve been obsessed with the dream. But maybe it wasn’t me falling to my death; maybe it was me flying.”], [The post A New HBO Series, ‘The Dark Wizard,’ Examines the Life and Death of Climbing Legend Dean Potter appeared first on Outside Online .],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 413, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

standard-article(title: [Try a Browser Sandbox! (For Free!)], author: [Peteris Krumins (catonmat)], source-name: [Peteris Krumins (catonmat)], images: (), paragraphs: ([TLDR: Want to browse the web safely without messing up your computer? Try a free browser sandbox at browserling.com/browse . It runs straight in your browser. No installs, no downloads.], [What’s a Browser Sandbox?], [A browser sandbox is like a “browser inside a browser”. It runs on another computer in the cloud, and you control it from your own screen. You get to surf the web, but the websites never touch your actual device.], [Is It Safe to Use?], [Yep! You can click on sketchy links or check out weird websites without any risk. All the dangerous stuff stays far away – on the remote computer, not yours. Even if a site tries to install a virus or download something, it won’t reach your actual system.], [Can I Open Suspicious Emails Safely?], [Yes, with a browser sandbox you can open sketchy emails or attachments without danger. If the attachment contains malware, it gets trapped inside the sandbox and can’t harm your real device.], [What About Testing Suspicious URLs?], [Absolutely. A browser sandbox is the safest way to test unknown URLs. It keeps malicious scripts, drive-by downloads, and tracking attempts locked away from your real system.], [Can I Use It for Digital Forensics?], [Yes, browser sandboxes are super useful for digital forensics work. Investigators can safely open phishing emails, suspicious websites, or malware links without risking their machines or leaking any data.], [Do I Need to Download Anything?], [Nope. Just open the sandbox , pick a browser, and start browsing. It’s that easy. Everything runs in your web browser via HTML5, JavaScript, and WebSockets, so there’s no software setup or weird permissions needed.], [Can I Try Different Browsers?], [Totally. You can switch between Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari, and even older versions if you’re testing an exploit that detonates in a particular browser version. This makes it useful for developers, bug bounty hunters, and cybersecurity researchers.], [Is It Free?], [There’s a free browser sandbox version with limited time. If you need more time or features, then there are paid plans too. The paid plans offer longer sessions, more browsers, and even persistent browser sessions.], [What Is Browserling?], [Browserling is an online tool that gives you access to free sandboxed browsers running on remote machines. Its use cases include safe browsing, testing websites in different browsers, and opening suspicious files and PDFs.], [Who Uses Browserling?], [Millions of people! Tech experts, digital forensics teams, IT departments, schools, and even government workers use Browserling. Big companies and researchers trust it too. Especially when checking out risky sites or testing code in different browsers.], [Happy browsing!],), insert-map: (:), word-count: 430, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false,)

If the attachment contains malware, it gets trapped inside the sandbox and can’t harm your real device.

Peteris Krumins (catonmat)

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Jeet Heer, *The Nation*: Jeet Heer

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The No Kings movement needs to become a mass anti-war movement.

The post [The Politicians Won't Stop This War. Only the People Can.](#) appeared first on [The Nation](#) .

Peter Nelson, Jalopnik: If you're even remotely interested in wrenching, you've probably heard of idler and tensioner pulleys, but if you're unsure which is which, step right this way.

GoCardless Blog, GoCardless Blog: Hear speakers from GoCardless and Open Banking Excellence as they demystify open banking and explain how businesses can use it to future proof their strategies

GoCardless Blog, GoCardless Blog: With new legislation being introduced to address the culture of slow payment, now is a great opportunity to help your SME clients get paid faster and more reliably

GoCardless Blog, GoCardless Blog: A Faster Payment is a type of electronic transfer, designed to speed up the process of sending money within the UK. This guide will tell you everything you need to know about the Faster Payments Service and how your business can use it.

Nelson Elhage, Nelson Elhage: Last time, I announced Check Plus, a declarative language for defining Check tests in C. This time, I want to talk about the tricks I used to implement a declarative minilanguage using the C preprocessor (and some GCC extensions). The Problem We want to write some toplevel declarations that look like: `#define SUITE_NAME example BEGIN_SUITE("Example test suite"); #define TEST_CASE core BEGIN_TEST_CASE("Core tests");` ... and so on, and somehow translate them into code that does the equivalent of:

Samuel A.A. Levine, Rich Maroko, The Nation: Samuel A. A. Levine, Rich Maroko

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New York's hotel industry was built on labor struggles—and today's protections show how worker rights and world-class hospitality go hand in hand.

The post [Tourists See a Luxury Hotel. We See Labor History and a City That Protects Workers.](#) appeared first on [The Nation](#) .

Chloe Clougher, Jalopnik: The Toyota 2000GT was rare, even when it was new, but the convertibles were so scarce just two were ever made. We decided to find out exactly why.

GoCardless Blog, GoCardless Blog: Are you getting the most out of your Direct Debit provider? We've put together 10 questions to help you find out.

GoCardless Blog, GoCardless Blog: GoCardless commissioned Forrester conduct a study to evaluate the costs and benefits for partners when integrating GoCardless Connect within their platforms to collect bank payments.

Dave Hunter, Vintage Guitar Magazine: Although future iterations would represent one of the most ubiquitous amp models in back lines across the country, a Fender Twin-Amp from its first full year of production has always been a sight to behold. The “Fender Twin” has been with us for so long that it has almost become a generic, which makes it [...]

Ali Skaik, The Nation: Ali Skaik

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This year, Eid was a declaration: We are here. We pray. We dress in our best. We love, even when the world tries to convince us that we have nothing to love or to live for.

The post In Gaza, Eid Is an Act of Resistance appeared first on The Nation .

GoCardless Blog, GoCardless Blog: Find out how your firm can work in partnership with large clients to help them fulfil new reporting requirements and enhance the overall performance of their payment processes.

Car and Driver, Car and Driver: See the interior and exterior of the new 535-hp Corvette Grand Sport and the 721-hp hybrid Grand Sport X from every angle.

Nelson Elhage, Nelson Elhage: (This is part three of a multi-part introduction to termios and terminal emulation on UNIX. Read part 1 or part 2 if you're new here) For my final entry on termios, I will be looking at job control in the shell (i.e. backgrounding and foreground jobs) and the very closely related topic of signal generation by termios, in response to INTR and friends. Sessions and Process Groups For the purposes of termios, processes are organized into two hierarchical groups, process groups and sessions.

Stanley Reed, The Nation: Stanley Reed

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Unless a resolution is found, the impact is likely to grow.

The post [How the War Has Led to the Largest Disruption of Energy Supplies in Decades](#) appeared first on [The Nation](#) .

Pete Prown, Vintage Guitar Magazine: Taylor's Gold Label Collection is the renowned builder's concept of a modern instrument that speaks to flat-tops of the 1930s and '40s. The 814e SB is a traditional non-cutaway fitted with Taylor trademarks like a bolt-on neck, super-quick fretboard, and electronics. The Gold Label 814e SB uses Taylor's Super Auditorium shape, which is larger than [...]

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